Software Requirements Specification (SRS) for Story Media Haven



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Prepared by Versatile Software Solutions

Change History

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of the Document

The purpose of this document is to provide a comprehensive set of requirements for the Story Media Haven software platform. This problem requires a software solution that blocks ratings from critics and prevents other media types from cluttering the user interface. By launching this software, we would provide a platform for people with high attention spans to be able to find amazing stories, in terms of books and movies, and share their opinions with their peers.

1.2 Scope of the Project

Our product, Story Media Haven, is for story-driven audiences who value narrative intent and coherent storytelling. The scope focuses exclusively on offering a dedicated platform for books and movies only, explicitly removing critics, avoiding "plot drift" associated with TV shows, and filtering out commercial biases.

The core software capabilities include:

- Global case-insensitive searching for book or movie titles.
- A 0-5 star numeric user rating system that updates average ratings in real-time.
- Text box areas allowing logged-in peers to write, edit, and delete personal text reviews.
- Dashboard-accessible favorite lists allowing users to save media.
- Secure user account registration and login protected by the bcrypt algorithm.
- An administrative moderation portal allowing system administrators to add media, manage pending queues from external publishers, and remove media or reviews.
- Media type filtering options to toggle display grids cleanly between books and movies.

1.3 Problem Statement

When it comes to rating movies, most online websites are filled with critics that often give biased or inaccurate reviews. Similarly, book websites often try to sell users new books that are deemed “best sellers” to make money from them.

The current solutions on the market can track books, but they can also track books, movies, and TV shows together. Furthermore, some websites can track books, movies, TV shows, video games, music, and podcasts together. These solutions ignore the story-driven audience. There is no dedicated place for books and movies only.

Our product, Story Media Haven, is for story-driven audiences who value narrative intent and coherent storytelling. Books and movies are written with purpose unlike TV shows that are usually produced to function as background entertainment instead of an experience that demands their full attention. As a result, TV shows experience “plot drift” whereas books and movies do not. If our audience were to use other products, they would have difficulty filtering out commercial biases and separating different media types.

This problem requires a software solution that blocks ratings from critics and prevents other media types from cluttering the user interface. By launching this software, we would provide a platform for people with high attention spans to be able to find amazing stories, in terms of books and movies, and share their opinions with their peers. Our product would remove the critics and offer community to those who love a good story that explicitly starts and ends, which is why it features primarily books and movies. Specifically, our users the ability to give their opinions about books and movies that they watched, and to find new favorites.

1.3 Stakeholders Involved

The following stakeholders will be affected by Story Media Haven in some capacity.

1.3.1 Users

Users encompass both Book Readers and Film Watchers, who serve as the primary consumers of Story Media Haven. They will use the platform to share authentic personal critiques, log their consumption histories, and discover new books and films based entirely on the reviews of their peers. To ensure high user satisfaction, Story Media Haven does not allow publisher marketing or professional critic scores. This provides an unbiased, peer-to-peer recommendation pipeline that prioritizes organic community sentiment over corporate influence.

1.3.2 Producers of Media

Producers of Media include Book Publishers, Independent Authors, and Film Producers, who act as external stakeholders directly affected by and involved in the software system. They actively participate in the ecosystem by using a dedicated portal to submit new media details. Because the platform's authentic peer reviews directly drive or diminish their media's discoverability and financial sales, their involvement ensures catalog accuracy while their business outcomes remain tied to community sentiment.

1.3.3 Platform Administrators

Platform Administrators are internal users responsible for managing the daily operations, content moderation, and underlying stability of the software system. They actively participate in the media pipeline by reviewing and approving new book and film requests from the administrative queue to prevent duplicate entries. Additionally, they oversee user-generated reviews and

maintain a well-organized system architecture to ensure the platform operates smoothly, remains fair for all stakeholders, and preserves an unbiased community ecosystem.

2. Overall Description

2.1 Product Perspective

Story Media Haven stands as a separate, specialized destination tailored explicitly for story-driven audiences who find current market solutions cluttered and unfocused. Unlike current tracking utilities on the market that aggregate books, movies, TV shows, video games, music, and podcasts into single feeds, this system establishes strict interface boundaries to block non-narrative clutter and commercial publisher/critic biases.

2.2 Product Functions

- **Search & Discovery**: Allows general users to execute searches and filter matching assets dynamically by target media classifications.
- **Peer Evaluation:** Empowers verified users to rate and publish written commentary directly underneath media details.
- **Account:** Provides a space for users to create profiles and to bookmark their favorite media.
- **Administrative Management:** Grants system administrators full database overwatch to create, approve, or delete titles and reviews.
- **External Intake Processing:** Interfaces directly with book publishers, independent authors, and film producers to ingest structural metadata requests into a validation queue.

2.3 User Characteristics

- **Book Readers:** Users looking to share direct peer assessments and discover new literature outside the promotional influence of book publishers.
- **Film Watchers:** Users seeking unclouded, peer-vetted cinematic selections completely isolated from standard critic review biases.
- **Platform Administrators:** Technical users requiring clean, organized code architecture to perform swift media management and database moderation chores.
- **Book Publishers, Independent Authors, & Film Producers:** Stakeholders affected by feedback markers, and sales impacts.

3. Specific Requirements

3.1 Functional Requirements

3.1.1 Title Search

The system shall be able to search for titles of a given book or movie within a search box regardless of letter case.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user wants to find a book or movie, when they type that media's name in the search box and click the search button, then that piece of media appears on the screen.
2. Given a user wants to find a title, when they type in the titles name in lower or uppercase letters, then the system will still recognize their request and provide the correct search results.

3.1.2 Media Rating System

The system shall give users the ability to rate a book or movie 0-5 stars.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user wants to rate a book or movie, when they click the review button, then the system will present a selection input that only allows numeric values between 0 and 5.
2. Given a user is on a media's detail page, when they select 4 stars and submit by using the selection input, then the rating is saved.
3. Given a user is on a media's detail page, when they select 4 stars and submit by using the selection input, then the book's average rating is updated.

3.1.3 Written Reviews

The system shall give the user the ability to write reviews in a textbox.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user wants to add a written review to a rating, when they click on the review button, then there will be a textbox below that will accept their written comments.

3.1.4 Saving Favorites

The system shall give the user the option to save media.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user wants to save their favorite book or movie, when they click the "Favorite" button on that media's page, then it gets saved to their favorites list which can be viewed under their account dashboard.

3.1.5 User Account Creation

The system shall allow a user to create an account.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a new user wants to access our platform, the system will allow them to create an account by providing a unique username, an email address, and 72 standard English character password. When the user provides these details on the sign-up screen and clicks submit, then a new user account is successfully generated in a database.

3.1.6 User Login

The system shall allow a user to log in.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given that a registered user wants to log in, the system shall grant access when the username and password match a registered account and otherwise display an error message without granting access.

3.1.7 Administrative Media Additon

The system shall allow system administrators to add media.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a system administrator wants to add a movie or book, when they input that media's details into the administrative panel and click "Submit", then that media is saved to the database and becomes immediately searchable and ratable by users.
2. Given a system administrator is reviewing the pending media request queue in the administrative panel, when they click "Approve and Submit" on a pending book or movie request, then that media is saved to the database.
3. Given a system administrator is reviewing the pending media request queue in the administrative panel, when they click "Approve and Submit" on a pending book or movie request, then that media becomes immediately searchable and ratable by users.
4. Given a system administrator is reviewing the pending media request queue in the administrative panel, when they click "Approve and Submit" on a pending book or movie request, then that media is removed from the pending request queue.

3.1.8 Administrative Media Removal

The system shall allow system administrators to remove media.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given an existing piece of media needs to be removed, when the system administrator selects that item in the administrative console and clicks "Delete", then that media is erased from the database and is no longer accessible to users.

3.1.9 Stakeholder Requests

The system shall allow book publishers, independent authors, and film producers to submit a media creation request containing the media's core details (Title, Author/Director, Release Date, and Synopsis) to an administrative moderation queue for review by a system administrator.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a registered publisher is on the submission portal, when they fill out all required metadata fields (Title, Author, Release Date, and Synopsis) and clicks "Submit", then the system validates that the title is not a duplicate.
2. Given a registered publisher is on the submission portal, when they fill out all required metadata fields (Title, Author, Release Date, and Synopsis) and clicks "Submit", then the system routes the details to a queue.
3. Given a registered publisher is on the submission portal, when they fill out all required metadata fields (Title, Author, Release Date, and Synopsis) and clicks "Submit", then the system displays a message stating: "Your request has been submitted for review.

3.1.10 Review Display

The system shall display, on each book or movie page, its average user rating and its written reviews.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user is on a media’s details page and the selected media item has existing user ratings or written reviews in the database, when the media details page fully loads, then the system shall display the current average user rating and written reviews associated with that title.

3.1.11 Type Filtering

The system shall let a user filter search results by media type (book or move).

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user has entered a search query and is viewing a list of mixed search results, when the user selects the “Book” filter from the media type filter options, then the system shall refresh the search results list and display only items classified as books, hiding all movie titles.
2. Given a user has entered a search query and is viewing a list of mixed search results, when the user selects the “Movie” filter from the media type filter options, then the

system shall refresh the search results list and display only items classified as movies, hiding all book titles.

3.1.12 Review Management and Moderation

The system shall let a user edit or delete their own review and let an administrator remove any review.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a registered user is logged into their account and they are viewing a review they previously authored, when the user modifies the review text and submits the changes, then the system shall update the review in the database and display the revised text.
2. Given a registered user is logged into their account and they are viewing a review they previously authored, when they click the “Remove Review” button on their review, then the system shall delete that review from the media page and show a confirmation message that the review has been removed.
3. Given a registered user is logged into their account and they are viewing a review they previously authored, when they click the “Remove Review” button on their review, then the system shall show a confirmation message that the review has been removed.
4. Given a registered user is logged into their account and when they are viewing someone else’s review, then the system shall hide the "Edit Review" and "Remove Review" options from that user.
5. Given a user logged in with an “Administrator” role is viewing any review on the platform, when the administrator clicks the “Remove Review” button, then the system shall delete that review from the media page.
6. Given a user logged in with an “Administrator” role is viewing any review on the platform, when the administrator clicks the “Remove Review” button, then the system shall show a confirmation message that the review has been removed

3.2 Non-Functional Requirements

3.2.1 Performance

In terms of performance, the system shall load the media in or below 5 seconds.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user wants to find a title, when they click the search button after entering the title’s name, then the user should not wait more than 5 seconds before all of the search results are loaded.

3.2.2 Security: Password Hashing

In terms of security, the system shall secure all user passwords using the bcrypt alogrithm with a work factor of 10, shall never store or log passwords in plain text, and compare provided passwords with the stored hashes.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user provides a valid password during sign-up, when the user submits their registration request, then the system shall hash the password using the bcrypt algorithm with a work factor of 10. and only store the irreversible hash string in the database.
2. Given a user provides a valid password during sign-up, when the user submits their registration request, then the system shall store the irreversible hash string in the database.
3. Given a user has previously signed up, when they provide a password during login, then the system shall hash the input and compare it to the stored hash to verify a match without ever decoding the original credential.

3.2.3 Security: Account Lockout

In terms of security, the system shall lock a user account for a duration of 15 minutes after five (5) consecutive failed login attempts.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user has a valid registered account, when an actor submits an incorrect password for that account's username five consecutive times, then the system shall temporarily disable the account for 15 minutes. and reset the failed attempt counter to zero once the 15-minute window passes.
2. Given a user's account is temporary disabled, when the 15-minute window passes, then the system shall enable the account.
3. Given a user's account is temporary disabled, when the 15-minute window passes, then the system shall reset the failed attempt counter to zero.
4. Given a user account is currently locked out due to failed login attempts, when anyone attempts to log into that account within the 15-minute window (even with the correct password), then the system shall reject the authentication request.
5. Given a user account is currently locked out due to failed login attempts, when anyone attempts to log into that account within the 15-minute window (even with the correct password), then the system shall show an error message that the account is temporarily disabled.

3.2.4 Usability

In terms of usability, a first-time user shall be able to find a title and submit a rating in under 2 minutes without consulting help documentation

Acceptance Criteria:

1. The following workflow should take 2 minutes or less: Given a new user has logged into the platform for the first time and is on the home dashboard, and the user has not viewed any help documentation (internal or external), when the user searches for a specific title using the global search bar and selects the correct media from the search results to open its details page and submits a rating or review or both.

3.2.5 Reliability

In terms of reliability, the system shall exhibit fault tolerance when processing queries for unavailable media types.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a user searches for media that does not exist in the database, when the system processes the invalid query, then the application shall contain the exception internally.
2. Given a user searches for media that does not exist in the database, when the system processes the invalid query, then the application shall prevent database corruption.
3. Given a user searches for media that does not exist in the database, when the system processes the invalid query, then the application shall return an error message.

3.2.6 Scalability

In terms of scalability, the system shall dynamically allocate memory and expand its storage capacity to accommodate newly added media without requiring manual reconfiguration.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Given a book or movie needs to be added to the database, when the system administrator adds the media and the current storage limit is reached, then the software shall automatically resize its database capacity to accept the new request.

4. Use Cases

4.1 Media Discovery and Review Workflow Use Case

Description:
This use case describes the workflow where a first-time user navigates the home dashboard to find a specific book or movie title, accesses its dedicated details page, and submits a numeric rating, written review, or both, completely without consulting any internal or external help documentation.

Actors:

- First-Time User: A newly registered individual logging into the platform for the very first time.
- System: The Story Media Haven application that processes search indexing, page loads, and data validation.

Pre-conditions:

- The first-time user has successfully logged into the platform.
- The user is currently positioned on the home dashboard.
- The user has not viewed or consulted any help documentation.

Post-conditions:

- The user successfully submits a rating, a written review, or both.
- The workflow is fully completed in 2 minutes or less.

Basic Flow:

1. The customer enters the name of a specific movie or book title into the global search bar on the home dashboard.
2. The customer clicks the search button to initiate the query.
3. The system loads and displays all relevant media search results in 5 seconds or less.
4. The customer selects the correct media item from the results list.
5. The system opens the dedicated details page for that media item.
6. The user inputs a numeric selection rating, authors comments in a text box, or completes both actions.
7. The user submits the entry directly through the interface.

Alternative Flows:

- *None specified.*

Exceptions:

- If a user searches for media that does not exist in the database:
    - The system internally contains the processing exception to maintain data integrity.
    - The application explicitly prevents database corruption.
    - The system returns and displays an error message to the user.

4.2 Media Rating and Review Workflow Use Case

Description:
This use case describes the workflow where a book reader or film watcher navigates to a specific media item's main page to submit a numeric rating between 0 and 5 stars, with the option to include a written review, which subsequently updates the item's global rating metrics.

Actors:

- User: A registered book reader or film watcher attempting to share their opinion on a specific piece of media.
- System: The application that displays media pages, calculates rating averages, and processes review data additions.

Pre-conditions:

- The user has successfully logged into their account.
- The user is positioned on the system search interface or dashboard.

Post-conditions:

- The user's numeric rating is saved and factored into the media's global score metrics.
- The updated average rating is instantly calculated and displayed on the media's main page.

Basic Flow:

1. The user searches for a specific book or movie title.
2. The user selects the book or movie from the search results and is taken to its main page.
3. The user clicks on the review button.
4. The system provides the user with an input space to give a rating between 0 and 5 stars by entering a numeric value.
5. The user provides their numeric rating and clicks "Submit".
6. The system adds the rating to the media's aggregate dataset, updates the overall average rating, and displays the new average on the main page.

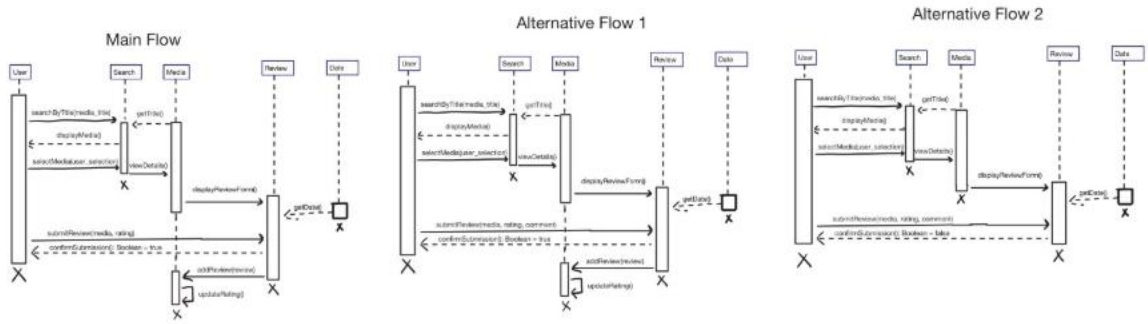
Alternative Flows:

- **Alternative Flow 1: User Adds a Written Review Along with a Rating**
  1. At step 4 of the basic flow, the system also provides a dedicated text space to author a written review.
  2. At step 5 of the basic flow, the user inputs both their numeric star rating and a written critique.
  3. At step 6 of the basic flow, the system publishes the text commentary directly underneath the media details while simultaneously updating and displaying the new average rating.

- **Alternative Flow 2: User Attempts to Submit a Written Review Without a Rating**
  1. At step 4 of the basic flow, the system also provides a dedicated text space to author a written review.

2. At step 5 of the basic flow, the user types out a written review but leaves the numeric star selection blank.
3. The user clicks "Submit".
4. The system rejects the submission, blocks the review from posting, and displays an error message informing the user that a rating is mandatory.

Sequence Diagram for the provided flows:



4.3 Media Metadata Submission Workflow Use Case

Description:

This use case describes the workflow where a publisher navigates to the submission portal to provide a new media item's core metadata, which the system validates for format compliance, authentication status, and duplication before routing it to the administrative queue.

Actors:

- **Publisher:** A book publisher, independent author, or film producer attempting to submit new media details to the platform.
- **System:** The application that verifies authentication, validates input formats, performs duplicate database checks, and routes submission requests.

Pre-conditions:

- The publisher has navigated to the dedicated stakeholder submission portal.

Post-conditions:

- The media metadata is successfully validated and placed into the moderation queue.
- The publisher receives a confirmation message indicating the request is under review.

Basic Flow:

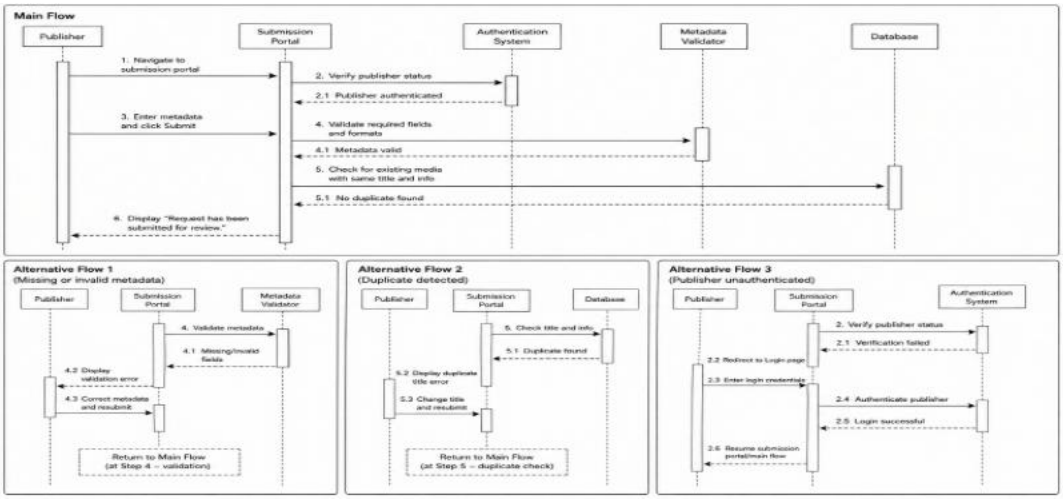
1. The publisher navigates to the submission portal.
2. The system verifies the publisher's registered authentication status.

3. The publisher enters the required metadata (Title, Author/Director, Release Date, and Synopsis) and clicks "Submit".
4. The system verifies that the entries in each field comply with the required structural format.
5. The system queries the database to check if a media item with the same title and metadata already exists.
6. The system confirms that the submitted title is not a duplicate.
7. The system displays a confirmation message stating: "Your request has been submitted for review."

Alternative Flows:

- **Alternative Flow 1: Required Metadata is Missing or Invalid**
    1. At step 4 of the basic flow, the system detects that required metadata fields are empty or formatted incorrectly.
    2. The system displays a specific error message highlighting the invalid metadata fields.
    3. The publisher corrects the input errors and clicks "Submit" again.
    4. The system returns to step 4 of the basic flow.
- **Alternative Flow 2: Duplicate Title is Detected**
    1. At step 5 of the basic flow, the system detects an existing database record matching the submitted title and core information.
    2. The system displays an error message informing the publisher that the media item is already registered.
    3. The publisher updates the metadata details to resolve the conflict and resubmits.
    4. The system returns to step 4 of the basic flow.
- **Alternative Flow 3: Publisher is Not Authenticated**
    1. At step 2 of the basic flow, the publisher's authentication status verification fails.
    2. The system redirects the user to the portal login page.
    3. The publisher successfully completes the login process.
    4. The system routes the publisher back to the submission portal and resumes step 2 of the basic flow.

Sequence Diagram for the provided flows:



5. Appendices

5.1 Class Diagram

